

Technical Presentation Template

Heitor Gama
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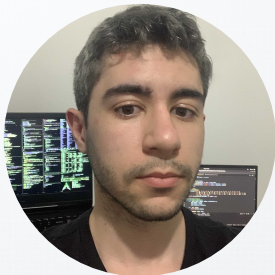
Course, project, seminar, supervisors or conference track

CROSSING

French Australian Laboratory for Humans-Autonomous Agents Teaming

About me

Heitor Gama



🌐 <https://www.heitor-gama.com>

- Computer Engineering student at Escola Politécnica da USP, double degree at CentraleSupélec.
- Research on Explainable AI at MICS, CentraleSupélec.
- Previous research with IRL CNRS Crossing on LLMs for multi-agent search-and-rescue settings.
- Interests include explainable AI, reinforcement learning, computer vision, technical competitions, and applied AI systems.
- Research experience across Brazil, France, and Australia.

Introduction

Start from the audience

One message per slide



- A slide is not a paper page. It should only support what the speaker says instead of replacing it.
- State the slide's purpose in the title or subtitle before adding visual detail.
- Prefer one central claim, comparison, diagram, table, or equation per slide.
- Reveal content step by step if the order helps the explanation.
- Move dense derivations, long code, and exhaustive tables to backup slides.

Use the title and subtitle deliberately

Make the frame readable before the content



- Use the title for the object of discussion, such as a method, result, limitation, or question.
- Subtitles are optional. I like to use them for the interpretation, the slide takeaway.
- If the slide needs a long explanation to be understood, split it.

Related Work

Structure the talk

Separate navigation from content



Part	What it should do
Opening	Establish the topic, speaker, affiliation, and talk context.
Motivation	Explain the problem and why the audience should care now.
Method	Show the bare minimum needed to understand the result.
Evidence	Present figures, tables, comparisons, or case studies.
Close	Summarize the contribution, limits, next steps, and contact path.

Table 1: A reusable talk structure. You might want to present your specific section summary at the start of the talk if the presentation is long.



Cite close to the claim

Footnote citations work well in talks

- Put citations near the exact claim they support.
- Use a footnote citation when the audience should see the source without interrupting the slide.¹
- Cite baselines, benchmarks, and reused methods when they shape your comparison.²
- Keep the references slide for checking details after the talk.
- Use a single bibliography style across all entries.

¹Huao Li et al. “Theory of Mind for Multi-Agent Collaboration via Large Language Models”. In: *Proceedings of the 2023 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing*. 2023, pp. 180–192.

²Chao Yu et al. “The Surprising Effectiveness of PPO in Cooperative Multi-Agent Games”. In: *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems* 35 (2022), pp. 24611–24624.

Methods

Prefer vector figures

Use raster formats only when the data is raster

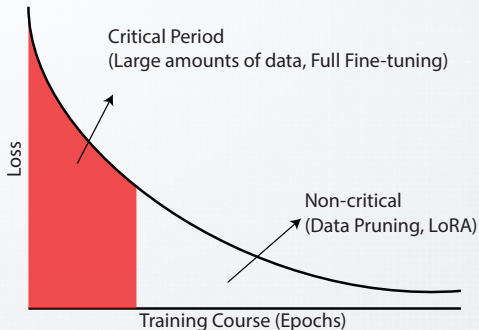


Figure 1: Vector diagrams and plots stay sharp when projected or exported.

- Images should be the clearest possible, even when projected on a large screen, low quality projectors or viewed from the back of a room.
- Use PDF for diagrams, plots, graphs, and schematic figures. In matplotlib, for example, it is very simple to save figures as PDF.
- Rebuild from scratch your diagrams in a vector format.
- PNG/JPEG allowed only for pixel-level image data or actual photos!



Keep equations compact

Define symbols immediately

- Show only the equation needed for the argument.
- Define every symbol before or immediately after the equation.

$$S = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^n w_i x_i, \tag{1}$$

where S is the summary score, x_i is one observed component, and w_i is its weight.

Results

Make tables earn their space

Show relevant comparisons



Version	Text density	Visual anchor	Audience task
Draft	High	None	Decode everything live
Readable	Medium	Highlighted row	Compare key cases
Talk-ready	Low	Claim + contrast	Remember the takeaway

Table 2: Use tables when precise comparison is the point. Highlight rows or columns discussed out loud.

Highlight the table before interpreting it

Use color or circles to direct attention



Agents	Map (#Nodes)	Score	Rounds to Completion	Valid Action %
o4-mini	Default (5)	90 ± 0.00	13 ± 3.00	95.83%
o4-mini	Medium (8)	90 ± 0.00	14 ± 3.46	97.22%
o4-mini	Hard (16)	90 ± 0.00	20 ± 3.46	98.80%
o4-mini	Village (53)	83.33 ± 11.55	79.33 ± 28.22	95.25%

Table 3: The complete table. Then one value circled. Then one row highlighted.

Highlight the table before interpreting it

Use color or circles to direct attention



Agents	Map (#Nodes)	Score	Rounds to Completion	Valid Action %
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Table 3: The complete table. Then one value circled. Then one row highlighted.

A circle is useful when only one number needs attention.

Highlight the table before interpreting it

Use color or circles to direct attention



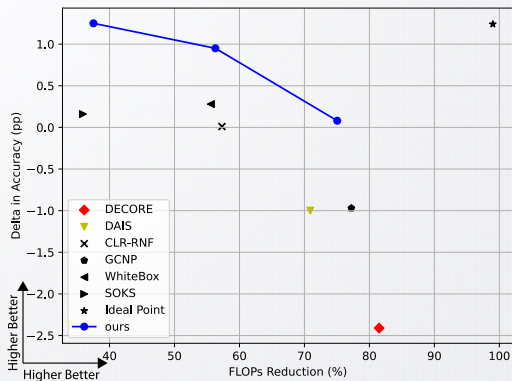
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Table 3: The complete table. Then one value circled. Then one row highlighted.

A row highlight is useful when the full case is being discussed.

Label visuals where readers look

Reduce caption dependency



- Captions are still useful, but the visual should not depend on them completely.
- Put labels and units in axis.
- Avoid plot titles that repeat the slide title.
- Use color plus shape, texture, line style, or text labels.

Figure 2: Different shape patterns help readers distinguish between groups and brings colorblind accessibility.

Discussion

Use backup slides

Keep the main story uncluttered



- Move extended tables, ablations, implementation details, and extra examples after the thank-you slide as a backup for questions that might arise.
- Keep backup slide titles searchable so you can quickly find them. For example, “Ablation: memory window”
- Mention limitations before the audience has to ask for them.
- If the work is preliminary, label claims as preliminary and explain what evidence is missing.

Explain comparisons fairly

Name what the baseline can and cannot show



- Say whether the comparison is against a prior method, an ablation, a random policy, or a human reference.
- Use the same task, data split, metric, and budget before claiming one method is better.
- When the method depends on a known algorithm, cite it where the method first appears.³
- Separate measured results from hypotheses about why the result happened.

³Guni Sharon et al. “Conflict-based search for optimal multi-agent pathfinding”. In: *Artificial Intelligence* 219 (2015), pp. 40–66.

Conclusion

Checklist

Practical formatting checks



- ☑ Figures are vectors and readable from a distance, with labels, units, and a citation when needed.
- ☑ Tables show only the rows and columns needed for the point being made. Highlight the relevant values you want to emphasize.
- ☑ Colors are not the only encoding for visuals. Pair them with labels, markers, order, or emphasis.
- ☑ Everything is labeled: figures, tables, equations, slides. People use those labels to ask questions.
- ☑ References use a single citation style.
- ☑ The PDF has been checked full-screen on the display aspect ratio used for the talk.
- ☑ Always have a physical pendrive with a backup copy of the presentation in case of technical issues.



References

Keep all entries in the same standard

- [1] Huao Li et al. “Theory of Mind for Multi-Agent Collaboration via Large Language Models”. In: *Proceedings of the 2023 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing*. 2023, pp. 180–192.
- [2] Guni Sharon et al. “Conflict-based search for optimal multi-agent pathfinding”. In: *Artificial Intelligence* 219 (2015), pp. 40–66.
- [3] Chao Yu et al. “The Surprising Effectiveness of PPO in Cooperative Multi-Agent Games”. In: *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems* 35 (2022), pp. 24611–24624.

Thank You!

Questions or comments?

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Backup

Backup slide pattern

Extra detail for questions



- Put material here when it is useful but would slow the main presentation.
- Try to predict what questions might arise or which parts of the presentation include hard concepts and prepare backup slides for them.
- Typical backup slides include full tables, additional figures, derivations, prompts, code snippets, and failure cases.
- Title each backup slide by the question it answers or the object it explains so you can quickly find them.
- Do not rely on backup slides to fix missing context in the main story. Most of the time you will not even have time to get to them.

Full figure without the main-slide compression

